Portside Logistics -- Hazmat Handling Procedures

Mandatory for all staff and drivers involved in loading, transporting, or unloading hazardous cargo.

1. Hazard Classes Carried by Portside Logistics

Portside Logistics is certified to carry a limited set of hazard classes: Class 3 flammable liquids, Class 8 corrosives, and Class 9 miscellaneous dangerous goods, each subject to the depot-specific volume limits set by the compliance team. Any shipment outside these classes must be declined at booking, not discovered at the dock.

2. Labeling and Placarding Requirements

Every hazmat package must carry the correct hazard class label before it reaches the loading dock, and the vehicle must display the matching placard for the highest hazard class on board before it leaves the depot. A vehicle missing the correct placard will not be dispatched.

3. Segregation and Loading Rules

Incompatible hazard classes may not be loaded in the same vehicle on the same run. Class 3 flammable liquids must be segregated from Class 8 corrosives by at least one empty bay or an approved segregation barrier, and loading staff confirm segregation before sign-off.

4. Personal Protective Equipment for Hazmat

Chemical-resistant gloves and splash goggles are required whenever handling Class 8 corrosives. A respirator rated for the specific chemical class is required for any Class 3 shipment with a damaged or leaking outer container, and that shipment must be isolated immediately rather than loaded.

5. Spill Response Steps

If a spill is discovered at the dock or on the road, the priority order is: stop the operation, secure the area so no one else approaches, and call the hazmat response line printed on the vehicle placard. Do not attempt cleanup beyond what the vehicle's spill kit is rated for, and never hose a spill toward a drain.

6. Driver Certification Requirement

Only drivers holding a current hazmat endorsement may be assigned a hazmat-carrying route. The endorsement must be renewed every 2 years, and dispatch will not assign a hazmat load to a driver whose endorsement expires within the trip window.